

England took the lead in the three-match Test series against New Zealand after an emphatic eight-wicket win in the opener. A returning Kane Williamson (93) propelled the Kiwis to 348 in the first innings, with support from Glenn Phillips (58 not out). However, Harry Brook's century dragged England back into the game, securing a 101-run lead. Although New Zealand managed to erase the deficit, Brydon Carse (**second from right**) shone with the ball once again, picking up six wickets and completing a 10-fer to restrict New Zealand to 254, despite a valiant effort from Daryl Mitchell. With only 104 needed to win, debutant Jacob Bethell brought up a fifty to take England across the line.



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South Africa outperformed Sri Lanka to win the first Test by 233 runs in the two-match series. Temba Bavuma scored a fighting 70 off 117 deliveries on his comeback as the host folded for 191 in the first innings. But Sri Lanka was bundled out for 42 — its lowest-ever Test total — in 83 balls (13.5 overs), courtesy of a seven-wicket haul by Marco Jansen (**left**). With a 149-run lead, skipper Bavuma (113) combined with Tristan Stubbs (122) to help the host post a mammoth target of 516. Dinesh Chandimal and Dhananjaya de Silva scored half-centuries, but Sri Lanka was eventually bowled out for 282, with Jansen picking up four more scalps to complete an 11-wicket haul.